GG-S-746A
March 30, 1972
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. GG-S-746
August 30, 1955

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

STAPLE REMOVERS, OFFICE TYPE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of staple removers for office use (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. Staple removers shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I. Plier type.
Type II. Tweezer type.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

GG-S-745 - Staplers and Staples, Paper Fastening, Office Type.
UU-P-121 - Paper, Bond and Writing, White and Colored.
UU-P-328 - Paper, Manifold.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-Up.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

FSC 7520

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activites outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Office in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Tariff Publishing Officer, Room 202 Union Station, 516 W. Jackson Blvd., Chicago, IL 60606.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Bid samples. One bid sample of each type offered shall be submitted with each bid and shall be examined for the following:

Visual examination of end-item (4.3.1).
Operational performance test (4.4).
Suitability of material used.
General appearance and workmanship.
Facility of use.
General "feel".

3.2 Materials. Materials in the staple removers shall be suitable in every respect for the intended service of the items and shall be free from any characteristics or defects which affect the appearance or which might adversely affect the functioning of the finished removers.

3.2.1 Metal. Metal used in the construction of the staple removers shall be 18-gauge steel (0.0478-inch with tolerances as permitted by American Iron and Steel Institute Steel Products Manual). Parts subjected to wear from contact with staples shall be case hardened to prevent wear. The coil or leaf spring shall be in accordance with good commercial practice.

3.2.2 Plastic. Plastic parts used in the construction of type II staple removers shall be non-flammable, slow-burning, or slow-burning to self-extinguishing type. Cellulose nitrate type plastic will not be acceptable.

3.3 Design and construction.

3.3.1 Type I staple removers shall be of all-metal construction and shall be comprised of four parts, two operating handles joined by a rivet and held apart by a spring of proper tension. The nose of one of the handles shall contain an extracting means at right angles to the handle, extending inwards, for insertion under the crown of the staple. The nose of the other handle shall exert pressure against the staple to permit insertion of the extracting means under the crown of the staple. Type I staple removers shall be similar to a plier in design. The over-all length shall be not less than 5 inches.

3.3.2 Type II staple removers shall be of metal construction with plastic finger grips. The staple removers shall have a pair of jaws, each with two prongs or an extracting means similar to that provided for type I, pivoted opposite the extracting and storing means. The remover jaws shall be metal and shall be kept separated by a coil or leaf spring of adequate tension. In the normal position the opening between the jaws shall be 5/32 inch, plus or minus 1/16 inch. Finger grips shall be not less than 1-3/8-inches across the grip portion and formed in a manner that will enable a user to grasp the tool comfortably and safely. Type II staple removers shall be designed to evolve a tweezer action. The over-all length shall be not less than 2 inches.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4 Strength of construction. The staple removers shall be constructed so as to establish and maintain proper alignment of the jaws. Face of prongs of the staple removers shall be sufficiently smooth for efficient operation.

3.5 Performance. The staple removers shall be safe, quick, easy acting, nonshooting, and shall not fracture the staples or tear the paper. They shall operate properly after being subjected to all test as required.

3.5.1 Type I staple removers shall extract heavy-duty staples and the holes in the paper caused by entrance of the staple shall not be expanded beyond 0.040 inch when the staple is removed, when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.

3.5.2 Type II staple removers shall extract standard duty staples and the holes in the paper cause by extrance of the staple shall not be expanded beyond 0.032 inch when the staple is removed, when tested in accordance with 4.4.2. When tested as described in 4.4.2.1, the expansion caused by the removal of the staple from the manifold paper shall not exceed 3/32 inch.

3.6 Rigidity. Individual parts of the staple removers, except coil or leaf springs, and each assembled staple remover shall be rigid during and after all tests for compliance with the requirements of this specification. Coil or leaf springs shall remain in satisfactory operating condition.

3.7 Finish. All metal parts of the staple removers shall be corrosion resistant or shall be chrome or nickelplated to resist corrosion. Commercially available colors of plastics will be acceptable.

3.8 Identification marking. The staple removers shall be stamped or embossed with the name of the manufacturer or his trade-mark.

3.9 Written instructions. Written instructions describing the manner in which the instrument is used to remove staples shall be furnished with each staple remover.

3.10 Workmanship. Finger grips shall have rounded edges. Particular attention shall be given to neatness of riveting, assembling, smoothness of the face, and freedom of parts from burrs and rough edges. The staple removers shall be free from defects which might affect the serviceability of the items and shall be free from any defects which affect the appearance of the product.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of all the staple removers presented for inspection at one time as defined in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 Sampling of end-item for visual defects. A random sample of staple removers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one staple remover.

4.2.3 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. For examination of interior packages the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, and selected at random just prior to the closing operation. Closure defects shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for end-item operation performance test. A random sample of staple removers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2. The AQL shall not exceed 6.5 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one staple remover.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual examination of end-item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table I. Any sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

TABLE I. Examination for visual defects

Examine	Defect
Material (3.2)	Not as specified.
Design and construction	
Type I (3.3.1)	Not as specified.
Type II (3.3.2)	Not as specified.
Finish (3.7)	Not as specified.
Identification marking (3.8)	Missing or not as specified.
Written instructions (3.9)	Missing.
Workmanship (3.10)	Not as specified.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Defects in preparation for delivery

Examine	Defects
Marking (interior and exterior container)	Omitted or incompleted. Incorrect or illegible. Improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged or otherwise defective. Any component not as specified.
Packaging	Improper method of closure. Box not compact or well filled.
Packing	Improper method of closure.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of liner, containers, flamps, strapping, or taping. Bulging, distorted, or damaged container.
Content	Number per container more or less than required.

4.4 Operational performance test. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be subjected to the following operational performance test:

4.4.1 Type I staple removers shall be made to remove 100 heavy-duty staples from 100 sheets of bond paper conforming to Federal Specification UU-P-121, type IV, basis weight 40 pounds (17 x 22 - 1,000). The staples shall conform to size 2, 1/2-inch leg length, and the stapler to type I, class A, style 2 of Federal Specification GG-S-745. The staples shall be seated to a firm standard clinch and extracted in the manner prescribed by the manufacturer of the staple remover. (Staples are to be considered fractured when broken into two or more pieces.) A No. 18 wire gauge (0.040 American or Brown and Sharpe) shall be used to determine excessive hole expansion.

4.4.2 Type II staple removers shall be made to remove 100 standard-duty staples from 30 sheets of bond paper conforming to Federal Specification UU-P-121, type IV, basis weight 40 pounds (17 x 22 - 1,000). The staples shall conform to size 1 and the stapler to type I, class A, style 1 of Federal Specification GG-S-745. The staples shall be seated to a firm standard clinch and extracted in a manner prescribed by the manufacturer of the staple remover. (Staples are to be considered fractured when broken into two or more pieces.) A No 20. wire gauge (0.032 American or Brown and Sharpe) shall be used to determine excessive hole expansion.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.2.1 Type II staples removers, after being subjected to the test described in 4.4.2, shall be made to remove 25 standard-duty staples from two sheets of manifold paper conforming to Federal Specification UU-P-328, Type V, basis weight 18 pounds (17 x 22 - 1,000). The stapler and staples shall conform to the requirements described in 4.4.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A and B. Each staple remover, of one type only, shall be packaged in a paperboard box.

5.1.2 Level C. The staple removers shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.1.3 Intermediate packaging. Twelve (12) packaged staple removers, of one type only, shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Intermediate packages of one type only, and in the quantities as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty-four (24) intermediate packages of one type only shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The staple removers shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination, at lowest rates, in containers complying with the Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. Interior containers and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 or MIL-STD-129, as specified (see 6.2).

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The type I staple remover is intended for use in extracting heavy-duty staples from paper and other objects. The type II staple remover is intended for use in extracting standard-duty staples from paper and other objects.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type of staple remover required (see 1.2).
c. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. Quantity for level A packing, when applicable (see 5.2.1).
e. Marking requirements (see 5.3).

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

POSTAL
POS

DOD has waived coordination interest.

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent, for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.